

WordPlay Privacy Policy

Effective date: November 1st 2025 **Last updated:** July 31st 2026

1. Who we are

WordPlay is a virtual reality rehabilitation application developed by Intelligent Interactive Internet of Things Lab at Duke University (534 Research Drive , Durham, North Carolina, 27705 , United States).

WordPlay is used in two settings, and what we collect differs between them:

Supervised research and clinical sessions. A participant uses the app under the supervision of a therapist or researcher, as part of an approved study. Motion recording is enabled in these sessions.

General use. The app is used outside a study. Motion recording is disabled and no recording files are produced.

This policy covers both. Where a practice applies only to research sessions, we say so.

For questions about this policy, contact alex.du@duke.edu .

2. What data we collect

2.1 Collected in all sessions

Meta account identifier. When the app starts it performs a platform entitlement check through the Meta Quest platform. This returns your Meta (Oculus) user ID and username. We use the numeric user ID as a stable identifier so that the app can tell players apart within a session and reconnect you to the correct role if you disconnect.

Session and networking information. A short room code you create or enter, the role you select (player or observer), and the network address of the device you connect from. This is required to route multiplayer traffic between headsets and our game server.

Play space measurements. The app reads the boundary you have drawn in your Quest system settings, and the floor height from your device's room scan. It uses these to place the virtual play area so it fits your physical space. We read these measurements; we do not receive images, photographs, or a 3D reconstruction of your room.

Shared spatial anchors. When two people play in the same physical room, the app uses Meta's colocation service to share a spatial anchor so both headsets agree on where the game is. The anchor is created and shared by Meta's platform service.

2.2 Collected only in research and clinical sessions, with consent

When motion recording is enabled, the app additionally records:

Head motion. The position and orientation of your headset, sampled approximately 30 times per second for the duration of the session.

Hand motion. If hand tracking is enabled on your device: wrist position and orientation, the positions of your five fingertips on each hand, per-finger pinch strength, hand size, and tracking confidence. Sampled at the same rate.

Body motion from optional external sensors. In some study protocols, wearable trackers are attached to the limbs or torso. Their position and orientation are recorded on the study computer. These sensors are separate hardware provided by the research team and are not part of your Quest headset.

Gameplay events. Round start and end times, and which stage of the game was active when.

These recordings are written to a file identified by your Meta user ID, on a computer controlled by the research team.

2.3 What we do not collect

We do not collect or record camera images or video from your headset, audio or voice recordings, eye tracking or face tracking data, your Meta friends list or social graph, payment information, or your precise geographic location.

We do not use advertising identifiers, and we do not run advertising or analytics SDKs.

3. How we use your data

To operate the app. The account identifier, session information, play space measurements, and spatial anchors exist to make the game work: to assign you a role, to place the play area safely inside your boundary, to keep two headsets in the same room spatially aligned, and to reconnect you if your connection drops.

For clinical assessment. In research and clinical sessions, motion recordings are used by the supervising therapist or researcher to assess movement — how far a participant travels, how quickly, how symmetrically, and how they reach and grasp. This is the purpose of the study you have consented to.

For research analysis and publication. Motion recordings are analyzed to produce measures such as movement path length, speed, and range of motion. Results may be published in aggregate or de-identified form.

We do not use your data for advertising, profiling, or automated decision-making, and we do not sell it or share it with data brokers.

4. Legal basis and research oversight

Research use of WordPlay is conducted under a protocol approved by the Duke University Institutional Review Board, protocol number 2026-0308 . Participation is voluntary and requires written informed consent obtained before any session.

If you are in the European Economic Area or the United Kingdom, our legal basis is your consent (GDPR Article 6(1)(a)), and for health-related data, your explicit consent (Article 9(2)(a)).

5. Who we share data with

Meta Platforms. The app runs on Meta Quest hardware and uses Meta platform services for account verification, avatars, and shared spatial anchors. Meta's own handling of that data is governed by the Meta Privacy Policy at <https://www.meta.com/legal/privacy-policy/>.

The research team. Motion recordings are accessible to the investigators and clinical staff named in the IRB protocol.

Nobody else. We do not sell your data, share it for advertising, or disclose it to third parties, except where we are legally required to do so, or as separately described in your consent form.

7. How to request deletion of your data

You can request deletion of your data at any time, from any country, free of charge.

Email alex.du@duke.edu with the subject line "WordPlay data deletion request". To help us locate your records, include the approximate dates of your sessions and, if you know it, your Meta account username. You do not need to give a reason.

We will confirm receipt within 7 business days and complete the deletion within 7 days. We will never charge a fee for this.

If you are a research participant, you may also withdraw from the study at any time by telling the study team, and withdrawal includes deletion of your recordings on the same terms.

When we may be unable to fulfil a request

There is one circumstance in which we cannot delete data, and we want to be clear about it in advance:

Once a recording has been **de-identified and combined into an aggregate dataset or published analysis**, the individual contribution can no longer be located or separated out, because the link back to your identity has been deliberately and irreversibly destroyed. That destruction is a privacy protection, not a way of retaining your data — but its consequence is that aggregated results cannot be undone.

This applies only to data already aggregated at the time we receive your request. Everything still held in identifiable form will be deleted. If any of your data has already been aggregated, we will tell you so when we respond.

8. Your rights

Depending on where you live, you may have the right to access the data we hold about you, correct it, delete it, restrict or object to how we use it, receive a copy in a portable format, and withdraw consent at any time without affecting the lawfulness of what came before.

To exercise any of these, email [\[PRIVACY CONTACT EMAIL\]](#). We apply these rights to all users regardless of region.

If you are in the EEA or UK you may also complain to your national data protection authority. If you are a California resident, we do not sell or share personal information as those terms are defined by the CCPA, and we will not discriminate against you for exercising your rights.

9. Children

WordPlay is not directed to children under 13, and we do not knowingly collect data from them. Meta Quest headsets have their own minimum age requirements.

[LEGAL REVIEW: If the study protocol enrolls minors, this section must be rewritten to describe parental consent and assent instead. Do not publish this wording if the protocol includes participants under 18.]

10. Security

Motion recordings are stored on access-controlled computers managed under Duke University's information security requirements. Access is limited to research personnel named in the IRB protocol.

Data travels between the headset and our servers over the local network or the internet.

No system is perfectly secure, but we take reasonable measures to protect your data and will notify affected users and the relevant authorities of a breach where required by law.

11. Changes to this policy

If we change this policy we will update the date at the top of this page. Where changes are significant and affect research participants, we will notify you and, where required, re-obtain consent.

12. Contact

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Duke IRB: alex.du@duke.edu, protocol 2026-0308`